

THE MECHA



A Mechanical Engineering Newsletter of Sorts.

WANT MORE MECH INFO? VISIT [CLUBMECH.SITES.OLT.UBC.CA](http://clubmech.sites.olt.ubc.ca) | FACEBOOK: MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | SEPT 28TH, 2015

Upcoming Events

Keep an eye out for more info on these events!

Mechstravaganza	October 23
Christmas Party	December
BEvERage Giveaway	Dec 4 (last day of classes!)

What do YOU want to see in the Mecha?

Send any ideas, thoughts, or opinions to:
ubcclubmech@gmail.com
We'd love to hear from you!

Units Every Engineer Should Know

1 inch $\approx$ 2.5 cm $\approx$ length of your thumb

1 yard = 3 ft $\approx$ 1 m

1 mile $\approx$ 1.5 km

1 km $\approx$ distance from the Cairn to the flagpole at the north end of Main Mall.

2000 lbs of Chinese soup = Won ton $\approx$ 1000 kg

1 lbf = $g \cdot 1 \text{ lbm} \approx 32.2 \frac{\text{ft} \cdot \text{lbm}}{\text{s}^2} \approx 4.5 \text{ N}$

450 graham crackers $\approx$ 1 lb cake

1 US gallon $\approx$ 3.8 L

1 imperial gallon $\approx$ 1.2 US gallons

Experiencing Investment Management through an Established Engineer

What is your company's main service?

We work with "Venture Capital", so we make investment decisions in promising tech: a product has been developed, but in truth the company around it is still young and working on understanding how they fit into the market, among other things.

What do you do as a Senior Investment Manager?

I find investible ideas. If something interesting comes along it goes from a conversation of "why I should do this investment" to the due diligence of trying to find reasons why we should not do the deal.

Why this field? Why this job?

It's fascinating. I get to work with a lot of smart, creative, driven, motivated people. A good

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entrepreneur is one who wants to change the world, to do something that's unique and different, and who is flexible, with a pile of creative ideas.

What tests your patience in your job?

With the entrepreneurs... being too rigid in their thinking. Being convinced they're right, instead of being open to learning from others and modify their views as they gather more info.

Do you have any advice for new engineers?

Be ready to move on when you feel like you're not learning enough or when you want to learn different things, be open-minded to listening, learning, and looking at everything from different angles, and follow what is of interest.

When I started out I had no perception that this is where my career would take me. Every job, every experience, every person you cross paths with – they have something to teach you, you just have to listen.

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Can you solve the puzzle? If you think you've figured it out, post your solution and how you got it as a comment under the full interview at clubmech.sites.olt.ubc.ca/. **The first person to post the correct method will receive a prize!**

Dear Diary,

Today I registered to vote in the 2015 Canadian Federal Election.

After hearing a ton (1000 kg) of hype about how important this election is, and how important my vote will be as an informed Canadian youth, I was determined to register early and get informed about voting!

Trusty Google got me to the Elections Canada webpage: www.elections.ca, where I was faced with the skill-testing first question of which language to proceed in. Diary, you know that my French is les misérables, so I selected English and we were off!

Now, I have voted in the past, but that was before I moved to BC. My first course of action was therefore to "Check or update [my] voter registration now". Canadian citizen? Older than 18? Yup. Oh diary, I hope all UBC Mechanical Engineering Students who fit that criteria also register to vote as soon as possible. Some pretty typical personal info (name, birthday, gender), but then they asked for my home address! Turns out I can use my permanent home address (my parents' house) OR where I'm living while at school!

And that's all it took! The website displayed the message, "You are registered to vote, at the address you provided" in large friendly letters, and I felt a twinge of federal pride.

Great! Now how do I vote?

The election will be held on Monday, October 19th, with advanced polls on the 9th, 10th, 11th, and 12th. But we can do better than that. Diary, I'm going to vote at an Election Canada office – there's one literally blocks away from my house, and it's open during regular business hours, seven days a week! Closer to UBC there's one at 1730 Broadway West (Broadway and Burrard), and it's open 9:00 to 9:00 Monday to Friday. This means I could cast my ballot today if I wanted to! I could mail in my vote, too, if I owned any archaic resources like envelopes or stamps.

Diary, now I need to figure out who to vote for! There are so many resources online – I used votecompass to get some perspective on how I fit in the political landscape. It lists out the main issues under consideration this election too, and shows where the different parties stand on each issue.

It's settled, Diary. Now that I know I can vote at an Election Canada office at my leisure, I *will* cast my vote before this week is out.

XOXO

University of British Columbia Engineering

Vancouver Centre	1125 Howe St, Suite 700	Burnaby North – Seymour	4567 Lougheed Hwy, Suite 223
Vancouver East	140 Hastings Street	Burnaby South	4601 Canada Way, Suite 400
Vancouver Granville	1730 Broadway West	New Westminster - Burnaby	620 Royal Avenue, Suite 200
Vancouver Kingsway	5550 Fraser Street	Richmond Centre	5300 No. 3 Road, Suite 842
Vancouver Quadra	4255 Arbutus St, Suite 260	Steveston – Richmond East	4600 Jacombs Road, Suite 210
Vancouver South	5780 Fraser Street	Surrey Centre	10249 King George Blvd
North Vancouver	126 15 th Street East, Suite 124	Surrey – Newton	7485 130 Street, Suite 101

All offices open Mon to Fri: 9:00am to 9:00pm Saturday: 9:00am to 6:00pm Sunday: 12:00pm to 4:00pm

SOMETHING TO SAY? FOUND SOMETHING COOL? EMAIL UBCCLUBMECH@GMAIL.COM TO CONTRIBUTE | SEPT 28TH, 2015